

ASHWIN SHOULD HAVE PLAYED IN EVERY MATCH OUTSIDE INDIA

It is unfortunate that the team management **did not consistently select Ashwin** to play in England, South Africa and Australia. This has always perplexed me.

Anil Kumble

Ravichandran Ashwin is a matchwinner. He is a thorough professional who has excelled throughout his career. Every time you watch him bowl, you can see that he wants to get better and is trying to outwit the batter in any circumstance. You want to see that in any cricketer, and he's done that for 14-15 years.

He is looking at identifying who the main threats could be from the opposition and invariably looks to be in the thick of the action. Look at the number of five-fors he has had. It tells you how much he matters to the team. Ashwin believes in being proactive and

staying one step ahead. He says, 'This is what I'm trying to do.'

The first time I saw him in person was probably during the 2011 IPL final against Chennai Super Kings (CSK), where he took those wickets against Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB). He has certainly evolved in terms of trying to understand his craft. It's not easy when you have that kind of expectation from the team and everyone else. Day in and day out, you expect him to pick up five wickets, and he does so consistently.

Unfortunately, the team management did